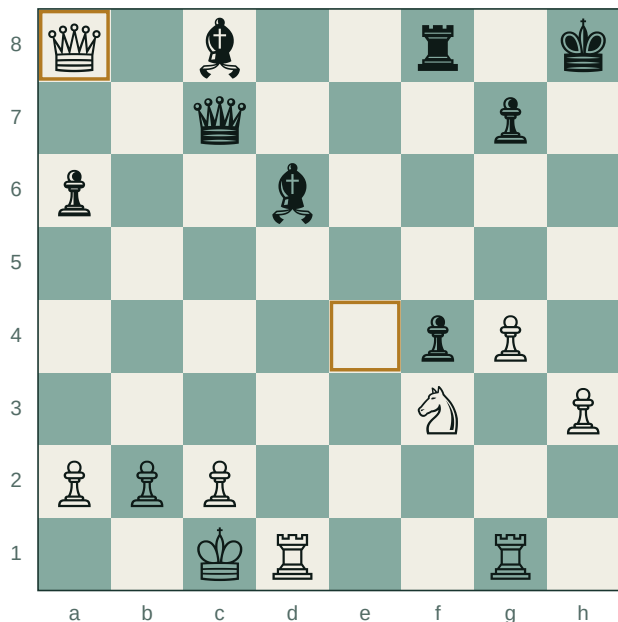


Interference tactics: Black, move 25

Interference tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 25.Qxa8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

25...Bb7 26. Qa7 Bxf3 27. Qxc7 Bxc7

25...Bb7 The bishop moves from c8 to b7. From b7 it attacks queen on a8 and knight on f3. Recorded reply: **26.Qa7**.

26...Bxf3 The bishop captures the knight on f3. The changed line means the queen on c7 attacks the queen on a7. Recorded reply: **27.Qxc7**.

27...Bxc7 The bishop captures the queen on c7.

At the end, nominal material is White 15 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -4 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on c1. Absolute pin: pawn on c2.